

DBS Group (DBSM.SI): First Take - Below GSe on lower other non-NII, though other key drivers were solid; 2026 guidance unchanged

DBS posted 4Q25 net profit of S\$2,258mn, -11% yoy/-24% qoq, -8% vs GSe. This quarter's miss came from: **(1) Weaker other Non-NII, -24% vs GSe**, on softer markets trading income. **This more than offset: (2) Stronger-than-expected fee income, +14%yoy**, with higher qoq cards income and stronger-than-expected wealth management fees, with NNM hitting highs of S\$12bn, **(3) In-line NII** with NIMs at 1.93% and loan growth of 1.8% qoq, **(4) Well-controlled expenses, with opex, -4% below GSe**, and CIR of 44.5%, **(5) Lower-than-expected CoC at 19bps**, as **higher SPs of 36bps was offset by GP write-backs**. **NPL ratio was stable at 1.0%**, though **NPL formation rose due to the prudent downgrade of a real estate exposure to NPL**, offset by higher upgrades and write-offs. **DBS will pay a total dividends of 81 cents for 4Q25, comprising 66 cents of ordinary dividends and 15 cents of capital return dividends.**

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For 2026, management maintained guidance with: (1) NII slightly below 2025 level (GSe +1%yoy) based on 2 Fed rate cuts, SORA at 1.25%, and a stronger SGD; (2) Commercial book non-interest income growth of high single digits, and mid-teens growth in wealth management (GS fee income 13% yoy); (3) Cost-to-income ratio to be in the low-40% range (GSe 40.6%), (4) SP to remain at 17-20bps, with potential for GP writebacks (GSe 19bps); (5) Net profit below 2025 level (GSe +4%yoy).

Though the quarter missed GSe on weaker other non-NII, all other key drivers were decent with good momentum in Wealth Management. We expect DBS shares to hold up. DBS will be holding a media briefing at 10.30am local time today, followed by an analyst briefing.

Key highlights:

- **Net interest income was in-line with GSe, -4% yoy/ +0% qoq.** Loan growth on a constant-currency basis was up 2% qoq/ 6% yoy, driven by growth in trade loans and WM loans.
- **NIM -3bps qoq to 1.93% vs Oct exit NIM of 1.92% and GSe of 1.92%.** The decline was driven by a 6bps qoq decline in commercial book NIM.
- **Non-interest income was below GSe, -26% qoq /-2% yoy.** Fees and commission income maintained the robust momentum, +14% yoy / -19% qoq, driven by wealth management fees. The lower non-NII was due to lower other non-interest income, -19% qoq / +14% yoy from lower markets trading income.
- **NPL ratio was stable at 1.0%**, with higher new NPL formation on the IBG book

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from downgrade of a previously watchlisted real estate exposure, offset by higher upgrades and write-offs, and NPA on the CBG book was also lower.

- **Credit cost came in at 19bps**, slightly below GSe of 20bps, including 36bps of SP and 17bps release of GP. LLR remained stable at 130%.
- **Expenses were in line with GSe, -1% yoy/ -1% qoq**. Cost-to-income ratio for the quarter was largely stable at 44.5%, vs. 4Q24's 43.5%.

Our 12-month target price (2-staged DDM-based) for DBS is S\$69.90. Key risks: (-) Unexpected acceleration in rate cuts; (-) Unexpected asset quality deterioration; (-) Mismanagement of top management transition. Maintain Buy.

Exhibit 1: 4Q25 earnings summary

Income statement (\$\$mn)	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	YoY %	QoQ %	4Q25E	Actual vs. Est (%)
Net Interest Income	3,728	3,681	3,648	3,578	3,593	(4)	0	3,612	(1)
Fee & Commission	968	1,275	1,167	1,357	1,099	14	(19)	1,054	4
Other Non-Interest Income	809	949	917	997	639	(21)	(36)	843	(24)
Non-Interest Income	1,777	2,224	2,084	2,354	1,738	(2)	(26)	1,897	(8)
Operating Income	5,505	5,905	5,732	5,932	5,331	(3)	(10)	5,509	(3)
Operating Expenses	(2,395)	(2,214)	(2,270)	(2,393)	(2,372)	(1)	(1)	(2,463)	(4)
Pre-Prov Op Profit (PPOP)	3,110	3,691	3,462	3,539	2,959	(5)	(16)	3,047	(3)
Loan Loss Provisions	(209)	(325)	(133)	(124)	(209)	0	69	(217)	(4)
Pre-tax Profit	2,960	3,437	3,388	3,482	2,792	(6)	(20)	2,908	(4)
Net Profit	2,523	2,897	2,824	2,954	2,258	(11)	(24)	2,446	(8)
Core Net Profit	2,623	2,897	2,824	2,954	2,358	(10)	(20)	2,546	(7)

Balance sheet (\$\$mn)	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	YoY %	QoQ %	4Q25E	Actual vs. Est (%)
Assets	827,219	840,823	841,896	881,622	897,488	8	2	893,246	0
Gross Loans	436,684	442,000	439,100	443,000	450,916	3.3	1.8	448,276	1
Non-Performing Loans	4,780	4,862	4,452	4,430	4,452	(7)	0	4,929	(10)
Customer Deposits	561,730	575,663	573,965	596,073	610,023	9	2	606,853	1

CAMEL Ratios (%)	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	YoY %	QoQ %	4Q25E	Actual vs. Est (%)
Core Tier 1	15.1	15.2	15.1	15.1	15.0			14.8	
NPL Ratio	1.09	1.10	1.01	1.00	1.00			1.10	
Loan Provisions / Average Loans (bps)	19	30	12	11	19			20	
Reported Net Interest Margin	2.15	2.12	2.05	1.96	1.93			1.92	
Cost-to-Income Ratio	43.5	37.5	39.6	40.3	44.5			44.7	
Loan-to-Deposits	77.7	76.8	76.5	74.3	73.9			73.9	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

DBSM.SI	12m Price Target: S\$69.90	Price: S\$59.30	Upside: 17.9%
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Buy	GS Forecast				
Market cap: S\$168.3bn / \$132.4bn	Net inc. (\$\$ mn)	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
3m ADTV: S\$227.2mn / \$176.4mn	EPS (\$\$)	11,409.0	11,121.3	11,542.8	12,239.1
Singapore	EPS growth (%)	4.01	3.92	4.10	4.38
Asia Financials	P/E (X)	10.9	(2.3)	4.6	6.8
M&A Rank: 3	P/B (X)	8.9	15.1	14.5	13.5
	ROA (%)	1.5	2.5	2.4	2.3
	ROE (%)	1.5	1.3	1.3	1.3
	Price/PPOP (X)	18.1	16.5	16.7	17.4
	Dividend yield (%)	12.6	12.3	11.8	11.1
		6.2	5.2	5.6	6.0
		9/25	12/25E	3/26E	6/26E
	EPS (\$\$)	1.04	0.86	1.07	1.02

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 6 Feb 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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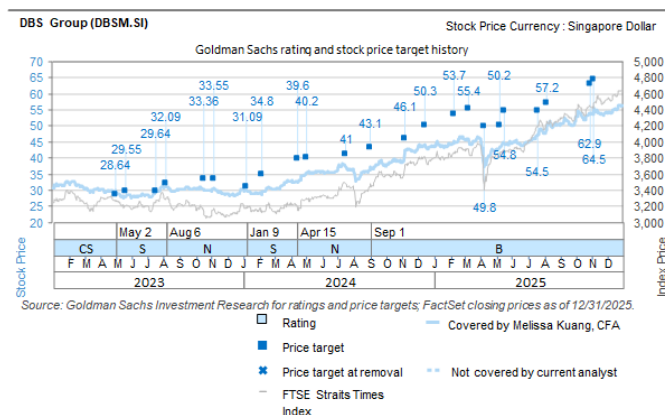
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